

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 5 of 6

THE TASK BOARD LESSON

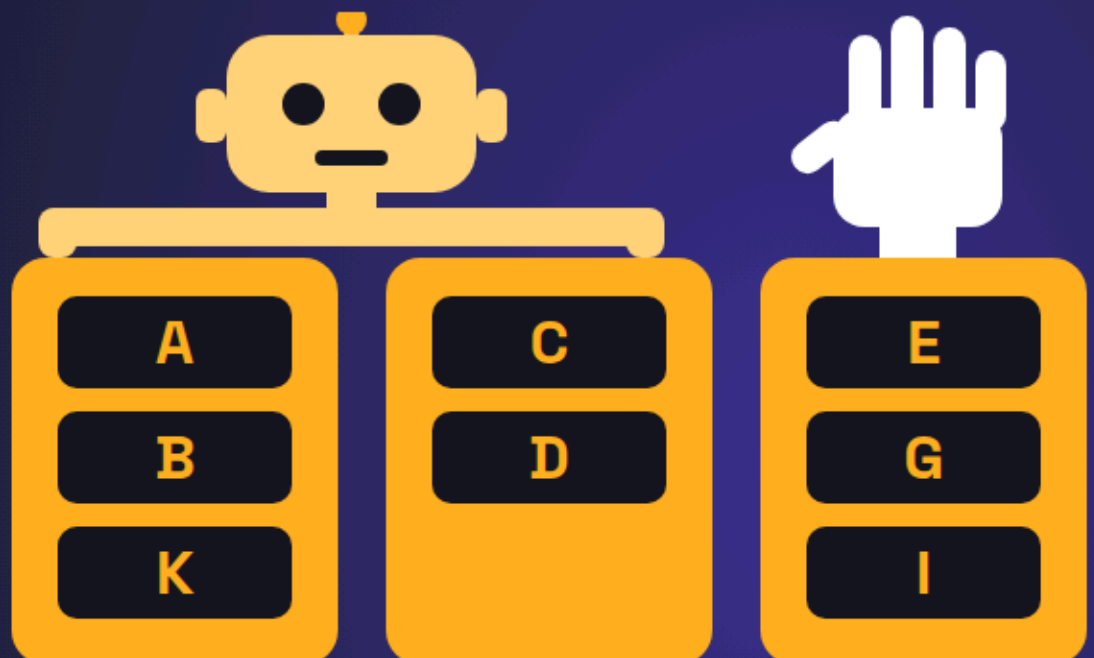
Robots Do the Boring Work

AI takes over **tasks**, not whole jobs.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

The Studio Task Board



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You run Big Dream Studio — a small recording studio. **Nia** owns the place and coaches the artists. **Ravi** runs the mixing boards. **Jaylen** runs the front desk. There's too much to do, so the crew just got an AI assistant. Your job: decide what it does — and what it never touches. Every decision (grown-ups say "a call") helps someone and costs someone.

- **AUTOMATE** — boring and repeating. Hand it to AI.
- **AUGMENT** — a human makes the call, AI helps out.
- **KEEP HUMAN** — coaching, taste, being there for someone. Humans only.

THIS WEEK AT BIG DREAM STUDIO

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>A. Send the "don't forget your session" texts to this week's artists (<i>Jaylen</i>)</p> <p>B. Rename and back up 300 audio files from last night (<i>Ravi</i>)</p> <p>C. Write the first draft of this week's social media captions (<i>Jaylen</i>)</p> <p>D. Mix a rough first version of a new artist's song (<i>Nia</i>)</p> <p>E. Coach a nervous first-time singer through her first recording (<i>Nia</i>)</p> <p>F. Politely remind three people who still haven't paid the studio (<i>Jaylen</i>)</p> | <p>G. Pick which of an artist's five new songs to release first (<i>Nia</i>)</p> <p>H. Set up the microphone for a live band and fix the echo (<i>Ravi</i>)</p> <p>I. Answer the price question with a group that wants the studio for five days (<i>Nia</i>)</p> <p>J. Type up the lyrics from yesterday's made-up-on-the-spot rap session (<i>Ravi</i>)</p> <p>K. Answer the same five questions everyone emails (price, hours, parking) (<i>Jaylen</i>)</p> <p>L. Plan the song order and mood for the big show night (<i>Nia</i>)</p> |
|---|---|

SORT THE BOARD

Write each task's letter in the column where it belongs — as many letters as belong there. **Every column needs at least two.** Disagree with your partner? Good — talk it out. That's the lesson.

AUTOMATE — HAND IT TO AI

AUGMENT — AI HELPS OUT

KEEP HUMAN — HUMANS ONLY

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key



Robots Do the Boring Work — the sort key for all twelve tasks, a key or exemplar for every student item (trade cards, the claim, the listener strip, the exit ticket), discussion moves, the Defense Rubric, what to do when it goes sideways, and full standards text.

WHY THIS LESSON

Students hear "AI is taking the jobs" everywhere, usually as a scare. This lesson swaps the fear for a decision-making frame: **let the robots do the boring work; leave the humans to do the human things.** Every AI job runs **human → AI → human**: a person decides what the AI takes on, the AI does the middle, and a person checks the result and owns the decision. The honest middle-school version, hedged on purpose: AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs — nobody can promise the final count — and every automation choice carries a tradeoff (CSTA 2-IC-20). Student pages say "the trade." *Stands* — nothing here depends on another lesson.

SUGGESTED SORTS — READ THIS FIRST

Honest note: most tasks are defensibly AUGMENT. The column numbers far less than the defense — a pair that puts D in KEEP HUMAN and names a real tradeoff by a pair that matches this table with no reason. Grade the trade, not the column. "Two per column" is fillable from this key, including the Support set (skip B, F, J, L).

TASK	LIKELY COLUMN	THE TRADEOFF WORTH SURFACING
A — Session reminder text	Automate	Wins hours back; a chirpy text after a cancellation stings.
B — Rename + back up files	Automate	Nobody misses it; the risk is silent failure — spot-check.
C — Edit social captions	Augment	AI drafts fast, but the studio's voice is Jaylen's.
D — Rough first mix of a new song	Augment	AI gets most of the way; Ravi's ears decide what ships.
E — Coach a nervous first-time singer	Keep human	Confidence is the point; a chatbot coach costs the singer.
F — Payment reminders	Automate	A job nobody wants; a loyal regular gets a cold nudge.
G — Pick the song to release first	Keep human / Augment	Taste is Nia's edge; AI can report trends, not decide.
H — Microphones + echo for a live band	Keep human / Augment	Craft plus judgment; AI can suggest, hands do the work.
I — Agree on a price	Keep human	Trust and reading the room; a bot can cost the booking.
J — Type up the rap lyrics	Automate	Transcription; it can mishear a line — the artist checks.
K — The same five email questions	Automate	Same answers daily; the risk is the sixth question.
L — Song order + mood for show night	Keep human / Augment	The mood is live connection; AI can draft the checklist.

THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson: your class runs a busy recording studio, decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human — and owns the tradeoff behind each choice. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) • Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) • board + marker for the three columns • Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) • pens	None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (Sort the Board; Exit Ticket)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, who could go wrong. (Trade Cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up to the back. (Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric)

CCSS.ELA.SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

"Is it boring because it **REPEATS** — something, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, calming someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let me argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridget: Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

What if nobody names a people-stuff job? Offer one: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

Transition: "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE LENS (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.